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Submitter Information

Name: Anonymous Anonymous

Email: [REDACTED]

General Comment

As an academic, a professional musician, and a published author, I have seen widely-touted advances in the field of AI in recent years. Having tried many of them for practical work-related tasks, it is my considered professional opinion that the Emperor has no clothes. This is an overhyped dead-end tech bubble that is destined to go the way of the Segway, Bored Ape NFTs, and Google Glass. I simply will never be persuaded that the future of American arts, letters, and industry is the technology that brought us "Willy's Chocolate Experience."

Artificial intelligence is like artificial lawns: there is no use for it if you have a real one. If I ever decide that I need a chat assistant to overconfidently give me incorrect answers with made-up sources, I can call my ex-brother-in-law.

As Sam Altman has rightly said, "It would be impossible to train today's leading AI models without using copyrighted materials." Well then, it should be impossible to train today's leading AI models, Q.E.D. If it is impossible for someone to get a billion dollars without defrauding working people and stealing intellectual property, then they should not get a billion dollars. This is not a morally or ethically difficult question except to thieves.

The best way to ensure American technological dominance is to see the AI scam for what it is, and instead invest heavily into supporting humans who are able to create and analyze with genuine intelligence and insight. A concrete policy action would be to pull all funding for OpenAI and invest it in education, the arts, and technology that actually has practical applications.